

Lenovo Legion Slim 5i

A solid gaming laptop, but you can get better for cheaper

The Lenovo Legion Slim 5i is the lighter and thinner version of the more powerful Lenovo Legion Pro 5. It sits snugly in between the new budget Lenovo LOQ 15 gaming laptop and the more premium Lenovo Legion Slim 7 series laptops. Lenovo has come out with both AMD and Intel variants of the new Lenovo Legion lineup, and we're going to be reviewing the Intel variant of the Lenovo Legion Slim 5i. We received the highest-end variant of the Lenovo Legion Slim 5i for this review; there are cheaper variants with weaker specs.

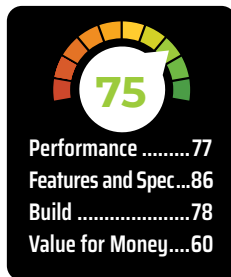
The laptop is pretty stacked in the specs department, and features a decent combination under the Rs 2 lac price point.

However, we already know that great specs on paper doesn't necessarily translate to good performance. Naturally, we put the laptop through our testing process to find out how well it performed. We'll get to those results as soon as we get through the build and design.

BUILD AND DESIGN

There's no denying that this is a sleek looking laptop. The Slim lineup has always been a lot more muted than the Pro lineup which has more of a "gamer" aesthetic in comparison. The vents, the base and lid all have a flat and clean design without a lot of the angles or protrusions that are normally expected in a gaming laptop. This gives the Lenovo Legion 5 Slim a very "professional" look overall, one which won't stand out even if you were

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to take this laptop with you to work. The Legion logo on the lid is clear and looks nice, but doesn't draw attention. The only giveaway would be the RGB backlighting on the keyboard when you open the laptop up.

The Lenovo Legion Slim 5i's build features a mix of both plastic and metal; like we mentioned earlier it sits between the mostly plastic budget LOQ series and the fully aluminium premium Legion 7 series. The balance is pretty solid. The laptop comes across as fairly sturdy. There's still some wobble on the lid when you open it, and there is some creaking when you attempt to flex the laptop's corners, but it's more than manageable. The display opens up a full 180 degrees as well.

The icons on the backside of the laptop are a great indicator for ports, however, other than the power indicator they don't light up like they do in the Legion 7 lineup.

Coming to the keyboard, Lenovo has had the same keyboard across its range of gaming laptops for a while

now, and it's still among the better ones out there. It doesn't have the travel or feedback of a mechanical keyboard, but if you've used a Lenovo laptop in the past, you'll have no problems here. Also, the Legion Slim 5 doesn't feature per-key RGB lighting, but 4-zone RGB lighting. You get per-key with the Legion 7s. The presence of a numpad the large arrow keys is always nice, especially in a gaming laptop where those keys might actually see some use. The touchpad is decent, but we found that it's placed a tad bit too much to the left. We'd often end up brushing against it with our palm while typing or gaming. Of course, if you're gaming you're most likely going to be plugging in a mouse and disabling the trackpad anyway but it can cause some confusion in-game.

I/O

Coming to I/O options on the Legion Slim 5i, you've got two USB-A 3.2 Gen 2 ports, with one of them being always on as long as the laptop is plugged in. Then you've got two USB-C 3.2 Gen 2 ports, an HDMI port, an RJ-45 ethernet port, an audio combo jack, and a card reader. There's no Thunderbolt 4 support, and only one of the USB-C ports supports Power Delivery. All of the ports are labelled nicely so there's no confusion as to what does what. The Legion Pro version has two additional USB ports, but the options on the Slim 5i should suffice for most users.

DISPLAY

The Lenovo Legion Slim 5i we're reviewing comes with a WQXGA (2560x1600) resolution IPS display with a refresh rate of 240Hz. Ours came with an advertised brightness of 500 nits. Cheaper variants of the Slim 5i feature displays with lower peak brightness of 300 nits, lower WUXGA (1920x1200) resolutions, and lower refresh rates (144Hz, and 165Hz).

During our testing, we got a peak advertised brightness of 491 nits which is very close to the advertised